Meerza went to the Russian Mission and I should think little will be done until the answer to the dispatches of the Russian minister arrive from St Petersburgh, and until the arrival of the Shah's mother who is away on a pilgrimage to Mecca. We expect both these arrivals within the next fifteen or twenty days. Bahman Meerza and the Shah are from the same mother, and it is supposed the younger son is the favourite. In fact the Shah has no affection for any one except the Prime minister even his own mother he has treated with unkindness. But she is a woman of great talent and energy and we, Bahman Meerza's followers, are anxiously wishing for her arrival, as we think her influence, if the king is not utterly dead to all sense of shame, may cause a change of measures. I have not yet been deprived of the offices I held under Bahman Meerza, the management of the villages and the kings stud but I fully expect to be so, as the heir apparent will most likely give these places to some of his own people. I shall not give them up until obliged to do so, as I am not sure yet but that I may have to remain in this province, and if so the more I have in my hands the better.

The Heir apparent[116] appears at present quite unfit for business, all the power and patronage is in the hands of a few of his own people: in fact since his arrival he has done little but give away places to those about him and amuse himself. Several men of the first rank and standing in the country for talent were appointed to come here as ministers; but not one has yet quitted Tehran, indeed they refuse to do so, until almost all the people who now surround the young Prince are removed, and ordered to return to Tehran. These last are making hay while the sun shines, and the Vale-Ahd (Heir apparent) seemed determined not to give them up. There will be some tremendous disputes between him and the prime minister in fact these have already begun, it will be curious to see how they will end; in fact things can not go on as at present, for in a short time there will not be a thousand pounds of available revenue in the province; all will be swallowed up by the young Prince's courtiers. Now when you consider that the Shah's great power consists in the troops drawn from this province,[117] which troops can not do altogether without pay and clothing, and with the rebellion raging in Khorassan, in a short time you may fancy what a mess they will be in.

This French revolution[118] (I mean that of last February for they may have had twenty others since that time) has of course destroyed the French influence in this country. In fact with M. Giuzot[119] one half of the diplomatic servants of the

116 Nasir-i-Din, then fifteen years of age.

117 The backbone of the army was composed of the levies from the province of Azerbaijan, of which Tabriz is the capital.

118 The abdication of Louis-Philippe in favor of his grandson precipitated the 1848 revolution which brought the Second Empire to an end, and inaugurated the brief Second Republic.

119 Guizot was Louis-Philippe's chief minister.

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